

MQF Professional Seminar

Winter 2026

PROFESSORS: Michael Melvin
DAY/TIME: Wednesday/11:30 am to 12:20 pm
LOCATION: Beyster Auditorium
EMAIL: mmelvin@ucsd.edu
OFFICE HOURS: by appointment

DESCRIPTION

MGTF416 Professional Seminar is a required one-credit course that counts towards your MFIN degree requirements. The Professional Seminar Series offers access to distinguished innovative leaders as well as professional skill development opportunities.

Your grade for this course is determined by your attendance and participation in the sessions, along with a 1-page summary of each class. **Documenting your participation is an important part of your academic record and to receive credit for the class you must attend every class.** Students will check in with Jessica and her helpers each class in order for their attendance to be recorded.

OBJECTIVES

This class will provide access to leaders in the financial industry so that students may learn about their career paths, their current roles, their firm, and the challenges they face in today's markets.

MATERIALS

None, but your full attention to the speaker is required. *There is a strict no phones or laptops policy in force during this class.* We are inviting distinguished executives from the industry, and we will all pay careful attention to their talk.

SCHEDULE

The class meets in Beyster Auditorium from 11:30-12:30pm on Wednesdays. Attendance is mandatory.

ASSIGNMENTS

Submit a 1-page summary of what your team learned from a session by Saturday after the session at 5pm. Summaries should be submitted via Canvas – there will be a 3-day submission window after each seminar. This is a team-based assignment but make sure the submitted summary includes the names of each member of the team.

Two potential questions you may answer to help structure your summary would be: a) What did you find valuable about this seminar? (what did you learn, what surprised you), b) What would have made this seminar more useful? (what questions do you still have, what needed further clarification).

GRADING

Grading is on a Satisfactory/Unsatisfactory basis (Pass/Fail). If you do not personally attend all sessions and your team does not submit the required summaries, you will fail the course

COURSE POLICIES

Every student in attendance should think of a question to ask when the speaker invites questions. It is embarrassing when the class has no questions for a speaker.

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

Integrity of scholarship is essential for an academic community. As members of the Rady School, we pledge ourselves to uphold the highest ethical standards. The University expects that both faculty and students will honor this principle and in so doing protect the validity of University intellectual work. For students, this means that all academic work will be done by the individual to whom it is assigned, without unauthorized aid of any kind.

The complete UCSD Policy on Integrity of Scholarship can be viewed at:
<http://senate.ucsd.edu/Operating-Procedures/Senate-Manual/Appendices/2>

STUDENTS WITH DISABILITIES

A student who has a disability or special need and requires an accommodation in order to have equal access to the classroom must register with the Office for Students with Disabilities (OSD). The OSD will determine what accommodations may be made and provide the necessary documentation to present to the faculty member.

The student must present the OSD letter of certification and OSD accommodation recommendation to the appropriate faculty member in order to initiate the request for accommodation in classes, examinations, or other academic program activities. **No accommodations can be implemented retroactively.**

Please visit the [OSD website](#) for further information or contact the Office for Students with Disabilities at (858) 534-4382 or osd@ucsd.edu.